

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 7
 ♥ 8 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 9
 ♣ 10 8 2

♠ Q J 4
 ♥ Q J 3
 ♦ K Q J 2
 ♣ A J 5



♠ A 10 8 5 3
 ♥ K 5
 ♦ 8 7 4 3
 ♣ 9 3

♠ 6 2
 ♥ A 10 9
 ♦ 10 6 5
 ♣ K Q 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North have seen the ♠4 and ♠2 so it is clear that East started with a 5-card suit. That means West still has a ♠. The instant you play a ♦ one of the defenders will grab the ♦A and East will take his three more ♠ tricks.

As much as you hate to put your contract in the hands of a 50% finesse chance, that is what you must do. Forget the ♦ suit and finesse East for the ♥K, trying for two extra tricks in ♥s.

East played very well to duck the second ♠, leaving his partner with a ♠ in case he could get the lead.

So you have to play well and stay away from ♦s.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. You aren't thrilled by all the Quacks in your hand but with 17 points you bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠5. West wins the first trick with the ♠K and returns the ♠9. East plays the ♠3 under your ♠J.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 7

You need 2 more tricks, and the ♦ suit will provide them after you drive out the ♦A.

Is that what you should do?

That is definitely **NOT** what you should do. East led the ♠5, then played the ♠3 to the second trick. You

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 5 4
 ♥ A 3 2
 ♦ Q J 10
 ♣ J 7 6

♠ 9 8 3 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 7 6 3

♣ K 10 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7

♥ K Q J 9 8 7 5

♦ A

♣ A 8 4 2

♠ Q J 10 6

♥ 6

♦ K 8 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♠

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by East

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 3

It can't do any good to ruff your fourth ♣ in dummy because you would have to lose two before that could happen. Of course one of your ♣s can be discarded on dummy's ♠K but what about the other two?

Suppose you win the ♠ and unblock the ♦A. Play ♥K, then to dummy's ♥A. Take one ♣ discard on the ♠K, then play the ♦Q and discard a second ♣.

It won't work. You would establish the ♦ for your last discard but you have no entry to it.

This will work. At trick 2 discard the ♦A on dummy's ♠K. Play the ♦Q and discard a ♣ when North doesn't cover. South will take the ♦K and attack ♣s but you are in control now. You win your ♣A, pull trumps, ending in dummy, and discard the remaining 2 ♣ losers on dummy's ♦J 10.

This is called a Jettison play. You sacrifice your ♦A to unblock the suit for dummy's ♦Q J 10.

If North held the ♦K the play would be slightly different; you would have to ruff when he covered. But the result would be the same.

Did you notice that you started with 3 ♣ losers and no ♦ loser, but you ended up losing 1 ♦ and no ♣s?

There would be nothing wrong with a transfer bid here, but probably no advantage either. What you really want to know is how many Aces partner has. So you ask him with a Gerber 4♣ bid.

Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

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Partner says 4♠ (2 Aces),

Looking at three possible ♣ losers you bid 6♥.

East plays 6♥. South leads the ♠Q. The first trick is easy; you win with dummy's ♠A.